

# go bag builder

*Build an emergency go-bag tailored to your actual household and your most likely local hazards — not a generic list — covering the people, pets, medications, documents, and hazard-specific items you'd need to grab and leave in minutes. Use when someone says 'build an emergency kit', 'what goes in a go-bag', 'prepare for evacuation', or 'emergency preparedness for my family'. Produces a personalised packing list, a grab-in-2-minutes core, storage and maintenance guidance, and per-person/per-pet additions. Points to official preparedness sources for your region.*

## Go-Bag Builder Skill

A go-bag is the difference between grabbing one packed bag and leaving in two minutes, versus running around gathering meds and documents while the situation worsens. Generic "72-hour kit" lists fail real households because they ignore the specifics that matter most — the baby's formula, the insulin that needs cool storage, the pet, the passport, the mobility aid — which are exactly the things you can't improvise in a hurry. This skill builds *your* go-bag: tailored to who's in your household and the hazards you actually face, with a grab-in-two-minutes core, and maintenance so it's not expired when you need it. It complements official preparedness guidance for your region, which it points to.

### What This Skill Produces

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- A **personalised packing list**: the standard essentials PLUS the household-specific items — per-person medications and copies of prescriptions, baby/child needs, pet supplies, mobility/medical equipment, and the hazard-specific additions for your area
- The **grab-in-2-minutes core**: the subset that must leave with you no matter what (meds, documents, phone/chargers, cash, keys, glasses) — so an evacuation isn't a scavenger hunt
- **Storage and maintenance guidance**: where to keep it, how to store meds/water/batteries that expire, and a rotation reminder so the kit stays current
- **Per-person and per-pet appendices**: individual needs so nobody's essentials are forgotten, including for family members who can't advocate for themselves

### Required Inputs

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Ask for (if not already provided):

- Who's in the household: adults, children (and ages), infants, elderly, anyone with medical/mobility needs, pets
- Where you live and the likely local hazards (or pair with [\[\[hazard-risk-map\]\]](#) to find

them) — flood, wildfire, quake, hurricane, extended outage, etc.

- Critical dependencies: prescription meds (and refrigeration needs), medical equipment, formula, service animals
- Constraints: budget, storage space, whether some people would evacuate separately

## Framework

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1. **Start from the household, not a template.** Enumerate every person and pet and their

non-negotiables — the medications, the equipment, the formula, the comfort item for a scared child. These are the items that can't be bought en route and that generic lists miss; they're the reason to build a *personal* bag.

2. **Layer in the hazard-specific gear.** A wildfire bag (masks, goggles), a flood bag

(waterproofing, water above all), a cold-climate bag (warmth), an earthquake bag (sturdy shoes, gloves) differ. Add the items your likely hazards demand rather than packing for disasters you'll never face.

3. **Define the grab-in-2-minutes core.** Not everything is equally urgent. The core —

meds, the [[emergency-doc-kit]], phone + charger/battery, cash, keys, glasses, whistle, a day of water — must be grabbable in one motion. Everything else is the fuller bag. Two tiers, clearly marked.

4. **Solve the expiry problem.** The reason go-bags fail: expired meds, dead batteries,

stale water, outdated documents. Store what expires so it rotates (a note on the calendar, meds you cycle through), and put a maintenance date on the bag. A go-bag is a habit, not a one-time purchase.

5. **Plan the people who can't pack themselves.** Infants, elderly relatives, anyone with

a disability, and pets each get an appendix so their essentials — and copies of their medical/care info — are in the bag. Also: where the bag lives so anyone in the household can grab it, and a smaller version for the car/work if relevant.

## Output Format

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### Grab-in-2-minutes core (must leave with you)

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[Meds · documents kit · phone+power · cash · keys · glasses · water — one grab]

### The full go-bag (personalised)

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Standard essentials: ... · Your household additions: ... · Hazard-specific for your area: ...

## Per person / per pet

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[Each individual's non-negotiables + copies of their medical/care info]

## Storage & maintenance

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[Where it lives (anyone can grab it) · rotate the expiring items · the maintenance date · car/work mini-version if relevant]

△ Pair with your region's official preparedness guidance (emergency agency / red-cross- type body) — hazards and advice are local. ``

## Quality Checks

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- ☐ The list is built from the actual household (people, ages, medical needs, pets),

not a generic template

- ☐ Hazard-specific items match the user's likely local hazards
- ☐ A clearly-marked grab-in-2-minutes core exists
- ☐ The expiry/maintenance problem is solved with rotation and a maintenance date
- ☐ Everyone who can't pack for themselves (infants, elderly, disabled, pets) has their

essentials covered

## Anti-Patterns

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- ☐ Do not hand over a generic 72-hour list — the personalisation is the entire value
- ☐ Do not pack for hazards the area doesn't face while missing the ones it does
- ☐ Do not ignore the expiry problem — an out-of-date kit is a false sense of security
- ☐ Do not forget medications, medical equipment, and the vulnerable household members —

these are the true non-negotiables

- ☐ Do not present this as a substitute for official emergency guidance or evacuation

orders — always follow the authorities in a real event

## Related

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[[hazard-risk-map]] to find your real hazards first; [[emergency-doc-kit]] is the documents core; [[power-outage-plan]] and [[after-the-disaster]] for during and after; [[family-emergency-plan]] for the household plan around it.